SSC MTS 2024 question paper with answers

4 November 2024 · Shift 1

79 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: 3 marks a question; no negative marking in Session-I (Numerical and Mathematical Ability, Reasoning), 1 mark deducted for each wrong answer in Session-II (General Awareness, English).

The other 11 of the paper's 90 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://ssc.gov.in/api/attachment/uploads/masterData/AnswerKeys/approved_writeup_26425.pdf

Numerical and Mathematical Ability 14 questions

Q.1

Find the simple interest (in ₹) on ₹2000 as a sum borrowed at 8% per year rate of interest for 4 years.

(A) 680
(B) 640
(C) 580
(D) 600

Q.2

The average weight of a family of five members (in kg) whose weights are 40 kg, 49 kg, 56 kg, 67 kg and 35 kg is:

(A) 49.4
(B) 51.4
(C) 48.4
(D) 50.4

Q.4

A shopkeeper offered following four different discount schemes for buyers on an item. A. Two successive discounts of 8%. B. A discount of 11% followed by a discount of 5%. C. Successive discounts of 13% and 3% D. A discount of 16%. Which discount scheme should be opted for getting the item at minimum price?

(A) C
(B) B
(C) D
(D) A

Q.5

The perimeter of a rhombus is 68 cm and one of its diagonals is 30 cm. Its area is:

(A) 230 cm^2
(B) 250 cm^2
(C) 245 cm^2
(D) 240 cm^2

Q.7

The rate of nickel plating on a metal is ₹50 / m^2. If the cost of nickel plating on a curved surface area of a solid hemisphere is ₹600, find the cost of nickel coating on the total surface area of this hemisphere.

(A) ₹900
(B) ₹1,000
(C) ₹800
(D) ₹700

Q.8

Find the simple interest (in ₹) on ₹3500 as a sum borrowed at 5% per year rate of interest for 4 years.

(A) 740
(B) 640
(C) 700
(D) 660

Q.10
The average weight of a family of five members (in kg) whose weights are 40 kg, 49 kg, 56 kg, 66 kg and 39 kg is:

(A) 51
(B) 50
(C) 49
(D) 52

Q.11
A person has to cover a distance of 8 km in 1 hour. If he covers one-fourth of the distance in one-third of the total time, then what should his speed (in km/h) be to cover the remaining distance in the remaining time so that the person reaches the destination exactly on time?

(A) 7
(B) 8
(C) 9
(D) 6

Q.12
A shopkeeper claims that he sells rock salt at ₹23 per kg, which costs him ₹25 per kg. But he gives 800 g instead of 1,000 g. What is his percentage profit or loss?

(A) Profit of 8%
(B) Loss of 5%
(C) Loss of 3%
(D) Profit of 15%

Q.13
How many seconds does Tiwari take to cover a distance of 600 m if he runs at a speed of 10 km/h?

(A) 216
(B) 200
(C) 205
(D) 212

Q.15
The ratio of the number of boys to that of girls in a school is 7 : 9. If the number of girls in the school is 189, then the number of boys in that school is:

(A) 168
(B) 147
(C) 126
(D) 105

Q.16
Ramesh sold a watch to Rahul at a gain of 10%, and Rahul sold it to Arun at a loss of 10%. If Arun paid ₹1,800 to Rahul, then for how much did Ramesh sell it to Rahul?

(A) ₹3,000
(B) ₹3,500
(C) ₹2,500
(D) ₹2,000

Q.17
The average of nine numbers is 6. When three new numbers are included, the average of the twelve numbers becomes 7.5. The average of three new numbers is:

(A) 12
(B) 12.5
(C) 8
(D) 11.5

Q.20
The salary of T in January, February and March is ₹15,000 per month. His salary in July, August, September, October, November and December is ₹30,000 per month. His average salary per month for the year is ₹27,000. What is his salary (in ₹) in April, May and June per month?

(A) 33000
(B) 28000
(C) 31000
(D) 25000

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving 15 questions

Q.1

In a certain code language, ‘eat your food’ is written as ‘wb hs lg’ and ‘food is tasty’ is writtenas ‘sw lj hs’. How is ‘food’ writtenin the given language?

(A) sw
(B) li
(C) hs
(D) lg

Q.2

Seven people C, H, A, P, T, E and R are sitting around a circular table, facing the centre (but not necessarily in the same order). T is sitting to the immediate right of E and to the immediate left of R. Only one person is sitting between E and C when counted from the left of E. Only one person is sitting between R and H when counted from the right of R. Who is sitting to the immediate left of C?

(A) H
(B) E
(C) P
(D) A

Q.4

Read the given statement(s) and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statement(s). Statements: All laptops are speakers. Some laptops are desktops. Conclusions: (I) Some speakers are desktops. (II) Some desktops are not laptops.

(A) Only conclusion II follows.
(B) Both conclusions I and II follow.
(C) Only conclusion I follows.
(D) Neither conclusion I nor II follows.

Q.5

In a certain code language, 'N E W S ' is coded as '2 @ 3 #' and 'D E W S' is coded as '4 @ 3 #". What is the code for 'D' in that language?

(A) @
(B) 3
(C) 2
(D) 4

Q.7

What should come in place of the question mark (?) in the given series? 483 502 521 540 559 ?

(A) 562
(B) 573
(C) 578
(D) 586

Q.9

What will come in place of the question mark (?) in the following equation if ‘+’ and ‘–’ are interchanged and ‘×’ and ‘÷’ are interchanged? 56 – 14 × 7 ÷ 22 + 63 = ?

(A) 35
(B) 37
(C) 13
(D) 63

Q.10

9 is related to 83 following a certain logic. Following the same logic, 13 is related to 171. To which ofthe following is 15 related, following the same logic?(NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbersinto its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding /subtracting /multiplying etc. to 13can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1and 3 is not allowed)

(A) 225
(B) 231
(C) 227
(D) 235

Q.11

WN 22 is related to AR 29 in a certain way. In the same way, MD 19 is related to QH 26. To which of the following is EV 35 related following the same logic?

(A) ZI 42
(B) IZ 42
(C) DK 42
(D) KD 42

Q.12

What should come in place of the question mark (?) in the given series based on the English alphabetical order? XDZ, THV, PLR, ?, HTJ

(A) MPN
(B) LPO
(C) KPO
(D) LPN

Q.13

Select the correct combination of mathematical signs that can sequentially replace the * signs and balance the given equation. 12 * 3 * 4 = 6 * 8 * 8

(A) +, ×, −, +
(B) ×, −, ×, +
(C) ×, +, ×, −
(D) ×, +, −, ×

Q.16

KGNI is related to LHOJ in a certain way based on the English alphabetical order. In the same way, GCJE is related to HDKF. To which of the following is OKRM related, following the same logic?

(A) PLSN
(B) LPSN
(C) LPNS
(D) PLNS

Q.17

Select the set in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following sets. (7, 40, 9) (9,71, 10) (NOTE : Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding /deleting /multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.)

(A) (8, 49, 12)
(B) (13, 150, 19)
(C) (5, 12, 18)
(D) (11, 106, 5)

Q.18

Seven people A, B, C, D, E, F and G are sitting around a circular table, facing away from the centre (but not necessarily in the same order). Exactly three people are sitting between E and B when counted from the right of E. C is sitting second to the left of B. A is sitting to the immediate right of D. E and F are not neighbours. How many people are sitting between C and A when counted from the right of C?

(A) 3
(B) 1
(C) 2
(D) 4

Q.19

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: All trees are branches. Some branches are leaves. Conclusions: (I) All leaves are branches. (II) All leave are trees.

(A) Neither conclusion (I) nor (II) follows
(B) Both conclusions (I) and (II) follow
(C) Only conclusion (I) follows.
(D) Only conclusion (II) follows.

Q.20

According to a code language, 256 means ‘they are nice’, 637 means ‘we are rude’ and 358 means ‘rude and nice’. What is the code for ‘nice’ in the same code language?

(A) 5
(B) 8
(C) 7
(D) 3

General Awareness 25 questions

Q.1

When did the Hockey wizard Major Dhyan Chand make his Olympic debut?

(A) 1936, Berlin
(B) 1928, Amsterdam
(C) 1932, Los Angeles
(D) 1924, Paris

Q.2

Sitara Devi was a classical dancer of India who used to perform _____.

(A) Sattriya
(B) Odissi
(C) Kathakali
(D) Kathak

Q.3

To which position in the Mughal administration under Akbar does Diwan-i-Ala refer?

(A) Defence Minister
(B) Court Writer
(C) Prime Minister
(D) Finance Minister

Q.4

The Republic Day parade is held every year at Kartavya Path, in which of the following cities?

(A) Jaipur
(B) Bangalore
(C) Dispur
(D) New Delhi

Q.5

Water from melting snow or rainfall or the spring drains downwards through an area of land and finally gets mixed into a large water body like river or ocean. This area of land is called:

(A) Bay
(B) Delta
(C) Drainage Basin
(D) Estuary

Q.6

According to Census 2011 of India, which Indian state has the highest urban population percentage?

(A) Mizoram
(B) Maharashtra
(C) Kerala
(D) Goa

Q.7

What is the year of foundation of the Women’s Indian Association (WIA)?

(A) 1917
(B) 1937
(C) 1927
(D) 1907

Q.8

Which dance guru of Kuchipudi dance got Padma Bhushan in 1998?

(A) Shobana Chandrakumar Pilai
(B) Guru Vempati Chinna Satyam
(C) Sonal Mansingh
(D) Guru Kelucharan Mohapatra

Q.9
In which neighbouring country of India is the Haa Summer Festival celebrated?

(A) Maldives
(B) Bhutan
(C) Afghanistan
(D) Sri Lanka

Q.10
In the Vedic period, education was begun with which of the following?

(A) Niyoga
(B) Upanayana
(C) Vanaprastha
(D) Grihastha

Q.11
Who among the following is appointed as the chairman of the 16th Finance Commission?

(A) Arvind Panagariya
(B) YV Reddy
(C) Dr Vijay Kelkar
(D) NK Singh

Q.12
With which Kathak gharana was Pandit Janki Prasad affiliated?

(A) Jaipur
(B) Rajgarh
(C) Lucknow
(D) Benaras

Q.13
Mukhya Mantri Sikho Kamao Yojana was launched by which of these state governments?

(A) Uttar Pradesh
(B) Madhya Pradesh
(C) Gujarat
(D) Maharashtra

Q.14
Australia won the Men's T20 World Cup Cricket in 2021 defeating New Zealand by _____.

(A) 8 runs
(B) 10 runs
(C) 8 wickets
(D) 10 wickets

Q.15
The memoir of which of the following actors is titled 'Unfinished'?

(A) Katrina Kaif
(B) Deepika Padukone
(C) Priyanka Chopra
(D) Alia Bhatt

Q.16
Which of the following Harappan cities was found without a citadel?

(A) Kalibangan
(B) Chanhudaro
(C) Banawali
(D) Lothal

Q.17
'Doabs' are found in which physical feature of India?

(A) The Peninsular Plateau
(B) The Northern Plains
(C) The Coastal Plains
(D) The Himalayan Mountains

Q.18
Which of the following Acts was the first intervention by the British government in the East India Company's territorial affairs?

(A) The Charter Act of 1813
(B) The Pitt's India Act, 1784
(C) The Regulating Act, 1773
(D) The Charter Act of 1793

Q.19

In which of the following groups of States and Union Territories is ‘slash and burn’ agriculture known as ‘Dipa’?

(A) Chhattisgarh and Andaman & Nicobar Islands
(B) Odisha and Puducherry
(C) Chhattisgarh and Lakshadweep
(D) Rajasthan and Andaman & Nicobar Islands

Q.20

What is the primary objective of Microfinance Institutions (MFIs) in India?

(A) To provide financial services to large corporations
(B) To fund government projects
(C) To generate profits for shareholders
(D) To offer financial assistance and services to low-income individuals and entrepreneurs

Q.21

The Indian Constitution originally consisted of how many Articles?

(A) 495
(B) 345
(C) 595
(D) 395

Q.22

A person with a very low count of red blood cells is medically known to have _____.

(A) Scurvy
(B) Jaundice
(C) Goitre
(D) Anaemia

Q.23

What is the term for the maximum population size that an environment can sustain indefinitely?

(A) Pioneer species
(B) Biotic potential
(C) Ecological niche
(D) Carrying capacity

Q.24

The space-filling model emphasises the relative size of each atom based on its _____.

(A) fixed radius for all atoms
(B) ionic radius
(C) van der Waals radius
(D) covalent radius

Q.25

On 16 February 2023, who was sworn in as the new Governor of Sikkim at Raj Bhawan, Gangtok?

(A) Shriniwas Dadasaheb Patil
(B) Ganga Prasad
(C) Pawan Chamling
(D) Lakshman Prasad Acharya

English Language and Comprehension 25 questions

Q.1

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Catch someone’s eye

(A) To surprise someone with unexpected behaviour
(B) To irritate or annoy someone intentionally
(C) To attract someone's attention or to be noticed by them
(D) To physically capture someone's gaze and hold it, making them unable to look away

Q.2

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error. This is one of best movies I have ever seen.

(A) one of best
(B) movies
(C) This is
(D) I have ever seen

Q.3

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Fondness

(A) Brilliance
(B) Dislike
(C) Liking
(D) Mistake

Q.4

Select the most appropriate adjective to fill in the blank. Among the three little cats, the first was _____ and the second was smaller.

(A) more small
(B) small
(C) most small
(D) most smallest

Q.5

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the highlighted word. Sonali uses a “soft” mattress to sleep.

(A) hard
(B) cushiony
(C) spongy
(D) flabby

Q.6

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Baker's Dozen

(A) A pile of bread
(B) One unit extra with one dozen
(C) Choosing quality over quantity
(D) When shopkeepers put something extra

Q.7

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select ‘No substitution required’. Mohit “have appreciated” Riya for her hard work.

(A) No substitution required
(B) have appreciates
(C) had appreciating
(D) has appreciated

Q.8

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. Although experts are worried / that retail inflation is rising / at a steep rate, / the crisis will soon blow away.

(A) the crisis will soon blow away
(B) Although experts are worried
(C) at a steep rate
(D) that retail inflation is rising

Q.9

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error. Much of the beauty and glory of life have disappeared.

(A) of life
(B) have disappeared.
(C) Much of the
(D) beauty and glory

Q.10

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Stories are how we make _____ of our lives and of the world.

(A) sagacious
(B) innate
(C) sense
(D) sensitivity

Q.11

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. He is the “friendly” man in the group.

(A) more friendly
(B) friendlier
(C) most friendly
(D) friendliest

Q.12

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. Departing or having departed from a country to settle elsewhere

(A) Excommunicate
(B) Emigrant
(C) Immigrant
(D) Native

Q.13

Rectify the sentence by selecting the correct spelling from the options. While threatening the integrity of Universal values, the campaign to spread democracy will not suceed.

(A) Sucseed
(B) Suucced
(C) Succsed
(D) Succeed

Q.14

Select the most appropriate synonym of the word given in brackets to fill in the blank. In the absence of her parents, the little girl felt _____ (lonely).

(A) crowded
(B) alone
(C) collectively
(D) sociable

Q.15

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. A room for cleaning and storing dishes and cooking utensils and for doing messy kitchen work.

(A) Scullery
(B) Sanatorium
(C) Dormitory
(D) Overlay

Q.16

Select the most appropriate ANOTNYM of the word 'zest' in the given sentence. The peppy and energetic music of the DJ was able to remove the passivity and dullness present in the party.

(A) peppy
(B) remove
(C) energetic
(D) dullness

Q.17

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. She asked if he could recount a moment when he felt completely “serene”.

(A) hilarious
(B) turbulent
(C) derogatory
(D) pacific

Q.18

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Search
(B) Creative
(C) Revaeled
(D) Multiple

Q.19

Select the option that rectifies the spelling error of the underlined word. The historic “cathedrel” stood as a symbol of faith and architectural marvel, drawing visitors from around the world.

(A) cathidrel
(B) cathedral
(C) cathedril
(D) cathidral

Q.20

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Despite facing numerous challenges, the team successfully _____ the project ahead of schedule.

(A) will be completed
(B) completed
(C) has been completed
(D) had completed

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The (1)_____ life in Kashmir was drawing to its end after three (2)_____ months. Miss Joan was leaving a week earlier than Mrs. Rhodes, and about two days before she left, I took her alone to the hotel for dinner. We walked to the hotel in (3)_____ silence, a silence so heavy that I could (4)_____ breathe. The hotel seemed to be far away and yet not far (5)_____.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) biquadratic
(B) mucolytic
(C) tonetic
(D) romantic

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The (1)_____ life in Kashmir was drawing to its end after three (2)_____ months. Miss Joan was leaving a week earlier than Mrs. Rhodes, and about two days before she left, I took her alone to the hotel for dinner. We walked to the hotel in (3)_____ silence, a silence so heavy that I could (4)_____ breathe. The hotel seemed to be far away and yet not far (5)_____.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) jealous
(B) anonymous
(C) analogous
(D) glorious

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The (1)_____ life in Kashmir was drawing to its end after three (2)_____ months. Miss Joan was leaving a week earlier than Mrs. Rhodes, and about two days before she left, I took her alone to the hotel for dinner. We walked to the hotel in (3)_____ silence, a silence so heavy that I could (4)_____ breathe. The hotel seemed to be far away and yet not far (5)_____.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) perfect
(B) slack
(C) direct
(D) select

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The (1)_____ life in Kashmir was drawing to its end after three (2)_____ months. Miss Joan was leaving a week earlier than Mrs. Rhodes, and about two days before she left, I took her alone to the hotel for dinner. We walked to the hotel in (3)_____ silence, a silence so heavy that I could (4)_____ breathe. The hotel seemed to be far away and yet not far (5)_____.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) gladly
(B) loudly
(C) gradually
(D) hardly

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The (1)_____ life in Kashmir was drawing to its end after three (2)_____ months. Miss Joan was leaving a week earlier than Mrs. Rhodes, and about two days before she left, I took her alone to the hotel for dinner. We walked to the hotel in (3)_____ silence, a silence so heavy that I could (4)_____ breathe. The hotel seemed to be far away and yet not far (5)_____.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) thorough
(B) clough
(C) enough
(D) overweigh

Answer key

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(C)**
Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(D)**	Q.13 **(A)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(D)**
Q.17 **(A)**	Q.20 **(A)**				

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.7 **(C)**	Q.9 **(B)**
Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(D)**	Q.13 **(C)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(B)**
Q.18 **(A)**	Q.19 **(A)**	Q.20 **(A)**			

General Awareness

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(D)**
Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(B)**	Q.9 **(B)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(D)**
Q.13 **(B)**	Q.14 **(C)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(C)**
Q.19 **(A)**	Q.20 **(D)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(C)**
Q.25 **(D)**					

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(B)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(B)**
Q.13 **(D)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(D)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(C)**
Q.19 **(B)**	Q.20 **(B)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(A)**	Q.24 **(D)**
Q.25 **(C)**					

Explanations

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.1 · Answer (B) 640

SI = 2000 × 8 × 4/100 = ₹640.

Q.2 · Answer (A) 49.4

(40 + 49 + 56 + 67 + 35)/5 = 247/5 = 49.4 kg.

Q.4 · Answer (C) D

The share of the price left: A 0.92 × 0.92 = 0.8464; B 0.89 × 0.95 = 0.8455; C 0.87 × 0.97 = 0.8439; D 0.84. D leaves the least, so the price is lowest.

Q.5 · Answer (D) 240 cm²

Each side is 68/4 = 17 cm and half the given diagonal 15 cm, so half the other is $\sqrt{(17^2 - 15^2)}$ = 8 cm and the diagonals are 30 and 16 cm. Area = ½ × 30 × 16 = 240 cm².

Q.7 · Answer (A) ₹900

₹600 at ₹50/m² means a curved surface of $2\pi r^2$ = 12 m². The total surface, $3\pi r^2$, is 1.5 times that, 18 m², and costs 18 × 50 = ₹900.

Q.8 · Answer (C) 700

SI = 3500 × 5 × 4/100 = ₹700.

Q.10 · Answer (B) 50

(40 + 49 + 56 + 66 + 39)/5 = 250/5 = 50 kg.

Q.11 · Answer (C) 9

A quarter of the distance, 2 km, takes a third of the hour, 20 minutes. The other 6 km must take the remaining 40 minutes (2/3 hour): 6 ÷ 2/3 = 9 km/h.

Q.12 · Answer (D) Profit of 15%

The 800 g he hands over costs him 0.8 × ₹25 = ₹20, and he charges ₹23 for it: a profit of 3/20 = 15%.

Q.13 · Answer (A) 216

10 km/h = 10 × 5/18 = 25/9 m/s, so 600 m takes 600 ÷ 25/9 = 216 seconds.

Q.15 · Answer (B) 147

Boys = 189 × 7/9 = 147.

Q.16 · Answer (D) ₹2,000

Rahul sold it at a 10% loss for ₹1,800, so he had bought it for 1,800/0.9 = ₹2,000: the price Ramesh sold it to him for.

Q.17 · Answer (A) 12

The nine numbers total 9 × 6 = 54 and the twelve 12 × 7.5 = 90, so the three new numbers total 36: an average of 12.

Q.20 · Answer (A) 33000

The year's total is 12 × 27,000 = ₹3,24,000. January to March give 3 × 15,000 = ₹45,000 and July to December 6 × 30,000 = ₹1,80,000, leaving ₹99,000 for April to June: ₹33,000 a month.

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving

Q.1 · Answer (C) hs

'food' is the only word in both phrases and 'hs' the only code in both, so food = hs.

Q.2 · Answer (A) H

Facing the centre, each person's left is clockwise. Clockwise, R, T and E sit together; C is second to E's left and H second to R's right. That gives, clockwise: E, (A or P), C, H, (P or A), R, T. The person to C's immediate left is H.

Q.4 · Answer (C) Only conclusion I follows.

The laptops that are desktops are also speakers, so some speakers are desktops (I). Nothing says any desktop lies outside the laptops, so II does not follow.

Q.5 · Answer (D) 4

E, W and S are in both words and @, 3 and # in both codes. The letter left in DEWS is D and the code left is 4, so D = 4.

Q.7 · Answer (C) 578

Each term is 19 more than the one before: 559 + 19 = 578.

Q.9 · Answer (B) 37

After interchanging the signs: 56 + 14 ÷ 7 × 22 – 63 = 56 + 44 – 63 = 37.

Q.10 · Answer (C) 227

Each number is related to its square plus 2: $9^2 + 2 = 83$ and $13^2 + 2 = 171$. So $15^2 + 2 = 227$.

Q.11 · Answer (B) IZ 42

Both letters move 4 places forward and the number rises by 7: WN 22 → AR 29 and MD 19 → QH 26. So EV 35 → IZ 42.

Q.12 · Answer (D) LPN

First letters move 4 back (X, T, P, L, H), second letters 4 forward (D, H, L, P, T) and third letters 4 back (Z, V, R, N, J): LPN.

Q.13 · Answer (C) ×, +, ×, –

12 × 3 + 4 = 40 and 6 × 8 – 8 = 40.

Q.16 · Answer (A) PLSN

Each letter moves 1 place forward: KGNI → LHOJ and GCJE → HDKF. So OKRM → PLSN.

Q.17 · Answer (B) (13, 150, 19)

The middle number is the square of the first minus the third: $7^2 – 9 = 40$ and $9^2 – 10 = 71$. Likewise $13^2 – 19 = 169 – 19 = 150$.

Q.18 · Answer (A) 3

Facing away from the centre, each person's right is clockwise. B is fourth to E's right and C second to B's left; D and A, side by side, fit only in the two seats after B, and F cannot sit next to E. Clockwise: E, G, C, F, B, D, A. Counting right from C come F, B and D before A: three people.

Q.19 · Answer (A) Neither conclusion (I) nor (II) follows

Some branches are leaves, but nothing says every leaf is a branch (I), and nothing links leaves to trees at all (II). Neither follows.

Q.20 · Answer (A) 5

'nice' is in the first and third phrases, and 5 is the only digit in both codes (256 and 358), so nice = 5.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (B) 1928, Amsterdam

Dhyan Chand first played at the Olympics in 1928 at Amsterdam, where India won its first Olympic hockey gold.

Q.2 · Answer (D) Kathak

Sitara Devi was one of the best-known Kathak dancers of the twentieth century.

Q.3 · Answer (D) Finance Minister
Under Akbar the Diwan-i-Ala (also called Diwan-i-Kul) headed revenue and finance: the finance minister. The Mir Bakhshi headed the military.

Q.4 · Answer (D) New Delhi
Kartavya Path (formerly Rajpath), where the Republic Day parade is held, is in New Delhi.

Q.5 · Answer (C) Drainage Basin
The area drained by a river and its tributaries is its drainage basin. A delta and an estuary form where a river meets the sea, and a bay is part of the sea.

Q.6 · Answer (D) Goa
In Census 2011 about 62% of Goa's people lived in urban areas, the highest share among the states.

Q.7 · Answer (A) 1917
The Women's Indian Association was founded at Adyar, Madras, in 1917 by Annie Besant, Margaret Cousins and others.

Q.8 · Answer (B) Guru Vempati Chinna Satyam
Vempati Chinna Satyam, the Kuchipudi guru who did much to bring the dance to the classical stage, received the Padma Bhushan in 1998. Kelucharan Mohapatra was an Odissi guru.

Q.9 · Answer (B) Bhutan
The Haa Summer Festival is held in the Haa Valley of western Bhutan.

Q.10 · Answer (B) Upanayana
Vedic education began with the Upanayana, the sacred-thread ceremony that marked a student's entry into study under a guru. Grihastha and Vanaprastha are stages of life.

Q.11 · Answer (A) Arvind Panagariya
Arvind Panagariya, a former Vice-Chairman of NITI Aayog, was appointed chairman of the 16th Finance Commission in December 2023. N K Singh chaired the 15th, Y V Reddy the 14th and Vijay Kelkar the 13th.

Q.12 · Answer (D) Benaras
Pandit Janki Prasad is regarded as the founder of the Benaras (Banaras) gharana of Kathak.

Q.13 · Answer (B) Madhya Pradesh
Madhya Pradesh launched the Mukhya Mantri Sikho Kamao Yojana in 2023: young people train on the job in industry and receive a monthly stipend.

Q.14 · Answer (C) 8 wickets
In the 2021 final at Dubai, Australia chased New Zealand's 172 for 4 and won by 8 wickets.

Q.15 · Answer (C) Priyanka Chopra
'Unfinished' (2021) is Priyanka Chopra's memoir.

Q.16 · Answer (B) Chanhudaro
Chanhudaro, in Sindh, is the Harappan city found without a citadel.

Q.17 · Answer (B) The Northern Plains
A doab is the land between two rivers that meet, such as the Ganga-Yamuna doab; doabs are typical of the Northern Plains, above all the Punjab plains.

Q.18 · Answer (C) The Regulating Act, 1773
The Regulating Act of 1773 was the British government's first step to control and regulate the East India Company's affairs in India; it made the Governor of Bengal the Governor-General.

Q.19 · Answer (A) Chhattisgarh and Andaman & Nicobar Islands
Slash-and-burn (shifting) cultivation is called 'Dipa' in the Bastar district of Chhattisgarh and in the Andaman and Nicobar Islands.

Q.20 · Answer (D) To offer financial assistance and services to low-income individuals and entrepreneurs
Microfinance institutions give small loans and other financial services to low-income people and small entrepreneurs who lack access to ordinary banking.

Q.21 · Answer (D) 395
The original Constitution had 395 Articles in 22 Parts and 8 Schedules.

Q.22 · Answer (D) Anaemia
Anaemia is a shortage of red blood cells or haemoglobin. Scurvy comes from lack of vitamin C and goitre from lack of iodine; jaundice is a build-up of bilirubin.

Q.23 · Answer (D) Carrying capacity
Carrying capacity is the largest population an environment can support indefinitely with its resources.

Q.24 · Answer (C) van der Waals radius
A space-filling model draws each atom as a sphere sized by its van der Waals radius, so it shows the space the molecule occupies.

Q.25 · Answer (D) Lakshman Prasad Acharya
Lakshman Prasad Acharya succeeded Ganga Prasad as Governor of Sikkim in February 2023.

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 · Answer (C) To attract someone's attention or to be noticed by them
To 'catch someone's eye' is to attract their attention.

Q.2 · Answer (A) one of best
'One of' takes the superlative with 'the': 'one of the best movies'.

Q.3 · Answer (C) Liking
'Fondness' is affection for someone or something: a 'liking'.

Q.4 · Answer (B) small
The first cat is simply described, so the positive degree 'small'; the second is then compared with it ('smaller'). 'More small' and 'most small' are not used for one-syllable 'small', and 'most smallest' is a double superlative.

Q.5 · Answer (A) hard
The opposite of 'soft' is 'hard'; 'cushiony' and 'spongy' are close to it in meaning.

Q.6 · Answer (B) One unit extra with one dozen
A baker's dozen is thirteen: a dozen and one extra.

Q.7 · Answer (D) has appreciated
'Mohit' is singular, so the present perfect takes 'has': 'Mohit has appreciated Riya'.

Q.8 · Answer (A) the crisis will soon blow away
A crisis that passes without lasting harm 'blows over'; 'blow away' means to be carried off by the wind.

Q.9 · Answer (B) have disappeared.
'Much of' an uncountable noun takes a singular verb: 'Much of the beauty and glory of life has disappeared.'

Q.10 · Answer (C) sense
To 'make sense of' something is to understand it.

Q.11 · Answer (D) friendliest
SSC's key gives 'friendliest': 'the … man in the group' calls for the superlative, and 'friendly', ending in '-y', usually takes '-iest'. 'Most friendly' is also found in standard English, so it is arguable too; 'more friendly' and 'friendlier' are comparatives.

Q.12 · Answer (B) Emigrant
An emigrant leaves his or her own country to settle in another; to the country of arrival the same person is an immigrant.

Q.13 · Answer (D) Succeed
The correct spelling is 'succeed'.

Q.14 · Answer (B) alone
Without her parents she felt 'alone', close in meaning to 'lonely'; 'crowded' and 'sociable' mean the opposite.

Q.15 · Answer (A) Scullery
A scullery is a small room next to a kitchen for washing dishes and other messy work.

Q.16 · Answer (D) dullness
'Zest' means energy and enthusiasm, which the sentence calls 'peppy and energetic'; its opposite there is 'dullness'.

Q.17 · Answer (B) turbulent
'Serene' means calm and untroubled; its opposite is 'turbulent'. 'Pacific' (peaceful) is a synonym.

Q.18 · Answer (C) Revaeled
The correct spelling is 'revealed'.

Q.19 · Answer (B) cathedral
The correct spelling is 'cathedral'.

Q.20 · Answer (B) completed
The sentence reports a finished action, so the simple past 'completed'. The passive forms do not fit a subject that does the completing, and 'had completed' would need a later past event.

Q.21 · Answer (D) romantic
'The romantic life in Kashmir': the other options are technical words from mathematics, medicine and phonetics that make no sense here.

Q.22 · Answer (D) glorious
Three 'glorious' months: a happy time that was drawing to its end.

Q.23 · Answer (A) perfect
They walked in 'perfect', that is complete, silence.

Q.24 · Answer (D) hardly
A silence so heavy that the writer could 'hardly' breathe: only with difficulty.

Q.25 · Answer (C) enough
'Far away and yet not far enough': 'enough' follows the adverb it qualifies.

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